



Von Gof Original Poster

Jan 13, 2021



Why have a Recovery Email Address, when Google will not allow you to use it?

I signed up for google on a Desktop PC, not a dang stinking phone. When I clean my computer using a program like CCleaner, Google won't let me resign into my account because they say they don't recognize my device. Google demands that I use a phone to verify my PC that I have used for years to use my google account. I have a recovery email address set up, but Google NEVER EVER offers the option to use this recovery email address.

When I click "Try Another Way" google just keeps asking to verify my account using my phone. No matter how many ways I try to recover my account, Google never offers an option of using a Backup Email or a Secret Question (both of which I have set up.

So, why won't google let me use the other recovery options I have? Why even offer these options if they are not going to let me use them. I know google wants to keep people secure, but they need to come to grips with the reality that not EVERYONE, has a dang smartphone, or wants one. Sorry, the PC is the best computing device ever invented and that is what I use. Not a smartphone.

Details

[Account Access & Recovery](#), [Web](#), [details_other](#)



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✓ Recommended Answer



Von Gof Original Poster

Jan 15, 2021



I have solved the problem. Fortunately, my laptop was still signed in, so I had access to the account. If I did not have this, I don't know what I would have done. To fix this problem too several steps.

1. I had to go into my account and disconnect the lost phone that google insisted on trying to use for verification.
2. I used a Google Voice number from a different google account and registered it as the recovery number on the account I was trying to recover.
3. I attempted to sign in on my PC and this time, instead of sending a verification notification to my lost phone, it allowed me to send a code via text to my google voice recovery number.

Boom! I now have access to my google account on my PC again.

I swear to God I want to choke whoever thought it was a good idea to tie security to a stinking smartphone. What kind of idiot s does google have working for them? Tying security to a device that is easily lost, stolen, or broken. INSANITY! This has to stop! It is ridiculous!

I have learned one thing from this. NEVER connect your dang phone to a google account!! NEVER! At least until google gets their head out of their ass and starts thinking again.

Original Poster [Von Gof](#) marked this as an answer

Helpful?

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✓ Recommended Answer



Von Gof Original Poster

Jan 14, 2021



Well, at least we agree on this. I don't mind phones, but I see an alarming trend that shows that one day we will be so tied to our phones that we will not be able to operate in society without them. Just like paper checks, plastic credit cards will one day be replaced by a smartphone of purchases. There are many pushing this right now. Once cash and cards are pushed out, the phone will be the only way to operate.

I hope not, but I see the trend going that way, and it is very disturbing.

Original Poster [Von Gof](#) marked this as an answer

Helpful?



 [View conversation](#)

✓ Recommended Answer



bkc56  Diamond Product Expert

Jan 14, 2021



I actually don't disagree about the over-dependence on mobile devices. I don't actually even own one, and don't have one configured on my account. I'm betting on 2SV and recover e-mail to get out of any issues I may ever have.

Original Poster [Von Gof](#) marked this as an answer

Helpful?



All Replies (12)



bkc56



Diamond Product Expert

Jan 13, 2021



Try letting the account sit for a full week with NO sign in or account recovery attempts. Just leave it idle for a week. This may help any suspicious activity flags to clear allowing you to attempt account recovery with more questions being asked (like the recovery e-mail).

The only account recovery option Google provides starts at <https://accounts.google.com/signin/recovery> (accounts can not be recovered through this user-to-user forum, and Google does not provide live support for account recovery). Assuming you posted here because account recovery isn't working, providing more accurate answers and using a known device/location/IP-address will help. You also need to read the following resources:

- <https://support.google.com/accounts/thread/2307038> - provides a brief overview of the process and sets expectations (not all accounts can be recovered).
- <http://gmailaccountrecovery.blogspot.com/> - a detailed description of the account recovery process that covers most any question one might have (be sure to read the "Let's Be Realistic" section).

Unfortunately, Google does not provide any escalation or review options for account recovery. If you are unable to prove ownership using the provided recovery process (plus the information in the above linked articles) then the account is lost. There are no other options. Starting a new thread will not help either. Sorry.

*Anyone else having a similar problem **needs to create a NEW thread** for their particular situation: <https://support.google.com/accounts/community>*



Von Gof Original Poster

Jan 14, 2021



This is about the most useless answer in the world. I am using a "**known device/location/IP-address.**" I am using a PC that I have used for years. You would have known this if you read my question. Every now and then I perform a PC clean up, and then Google thinks it is a different device.

My question is simple. Why does google offer three recovery options (i.e, Phone/Email/Secret Question) when they are only going to allow you to use one? Why have the other two options if they are not going to be used?

I tried to log on just not and went through all the options and I always end up at this screen, that basically says, "You can only use your phone to recover this account."



The image is not visible due to forum settings.

Well, I am sorry, that phone is at the bottom of a lake.

LET ME USE MY DANG BACKUP EMAIL TO RECOVER MY ACCOUNT!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

Last edited Jan 14, 2021



bkc56 Diamond Product Expert

Jan 14, 2021



This is about the most useless answer in the world.

<shrug> I've told you what to try. Do it, or don't.



Von Gof Original Poster

Jan 14, 2021



You told me to wait a week.

1. That is not an answer to the question (Why have a recovery email address, when Google will not allow you to use it?).
2. At best, your suggestion is a shot in the dark hypothetical gamble, which costs me a week of wasted time to try.
3. I have no choice but to wait, because Google is offering no other options, so your suggestion is moot, because it is literally the ONLY course of action left to me. LOL!



bkc56 Diamond Product Expert

Jan 14, 2021



That is not an answer to the question ...

I don't know why Google sometimes restricts the account recovery options. I suspect it is related to unusual or suspicious activity on the account. It's possible clearing browser cookies as part of cleaning your PC might be related. Having an out-of-date phone on the account means you can't do the verification, which probably adds to the suspicious status.

At best, your suggestion is a shot in the dark hypothetical gamble

Nope. Not even close. It's a procedure that has a long track-record of helping with a variety of recovery problems. Will it help with yours? We can hope so.

so your suggestion is moot

Actually, no. The suggestion is more than just waiting.



Von Gof Original Poster

Jan 14, 2021



Here is the deal. I am a PC person. A phone is just an accessory to my PC. I use my PC 98% to do everything on the internet. I only use my phone when I am away from my PC or Laptop. I do not like being tied to my phone as a security measure. I don't like this whole trend of making a phone a requirement to operate on the internet. I think it is morally wrong for google to demand that you MUST have a phone. Phone cost money, to keep and maintain. So google is forcing me to spend lots of money to use their service.

The phone in question that google wants to use to verify my account is under 100 feet of water at the bottom of the ocean. It is not coming back. Phones are lost daily! I once left a phone on top of my car and it fell off and was run over by a semi doing 70. I had another phone that fell off the couch and completely stopped working.

It is an unthinkable exercise in utter stupidity to tie the security of a google account to a delicate device like a smartphone that can be lost, stolen, or broken at any point. For them to provide no other options for account recovery is so mind-boggling dumb, it surpasses my linguistic ability to describe.

Since I want to believe that there is at least one intelligent person working at google, I refuse to accept that there is no other option to recover my account in a quick and reasonable fashion. Wait a week to TRY, is not what I consider a Quick and Reasonable fashion.

You obviously think everyone working at google is as stupid as I have just suggested, and thus have accepted that the only recourse is to sit around twiddling your thumbs for a week in the hopes that somehow by magic, the problem will go away.

I thank you for your suggestion then, and I will continue on my journey to find someone who has a better suggestion.

Last edited Jan 14, 2021



bkc56



Diamond Product Expert



Recommended Answer

Jan 14, 2021



I actually don't disagree about the over-dependence on mobile devices. I don't actually even own one, and don't have one configured on my account. I'm betting on 2SV and recover e-mail to get out of any issues I may ever have.

Original Poster [Von Gof](#) marked this as an answer



[Von Gof](#)

Original Poster



Recommended Answer

Jan 14, 2021



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Original Poster [Von Gof](#) marked this as an answer



[Von Gof](#)

Original Poster

Jan 14, 2021



So here is another crazy development. I found out that my laptop is still signed into my google account. So I accessed my gmail, and there were a bunch of alerts from all my attempts to log in. I went through each one and confirmed that "Yes, It Was Me" that is trying to sign in. But guess what? Google still says that my device cannot be verified without that stupid phone.

So. I know my password. I know my Email Recovery address. I know my Secret Question answer. I am in the same Location I have always logged in from. I am using the same ISP I have used for the last 10 years. I have the same IP address. And I have confirmed that this is me from another device and Google STILL will not let me log in without that damb phone!!!

I am really starting to hate Google with a passion of immeasurable proportions. This is utterly ridiculous!!!!



Google user

Jan 14, 2021



Thank you for offering suggestions!

Many problems started when I switched due to Verizon's inability and refusal to switch my info when I bought the new phone.

I am disappointed in them for not doing more than turn on my new phone. Frustrated as I went back to the store I bought it at...and tried to ask for help.

Totally turned away, and when they left walked right by me...



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Recommended Answer Jan 15, 2021



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Original Poster [Von Gof](#) marked this as an answer



bkc56



Diamond Product Expert

Jan 15, 2021



I'm glad you got back into the account.

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